

Uses



Spark plug

This plug contains an alloy of barium and nickel.



Glass-making

This glass can be made shinier by adding barium oxide and barium carbonate.

This pot is made from clay that is rich in barium.



Jasperware pot



Vacuum tube

The barium in the metallic strip absorbs gases in the tube, maintaining a vacuum.

The intestine is filled with a barium solution.



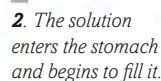
X-ray scan

BARIUM SOLUTION

Barium is used in a medical test for checking a patient's digestive tract for problems. In this test, a patient swallows a barium liquid solution, which fills the organs in the digestive tract.



1. The barium solution is ingested.



2. The solution enters the stomach and begins to fill it.



3. Under an X-ray scan, the barium-filled stomach shows up clearly.

element is used in **spark plugs** to make them produce more powerful sparks and is added to **glass** to increase its shine. Barium compounds are added to some types of clay used for making **pots** and vases. In oil wells, barium compounds are added to drilling fluids to increase their

density. Doctors make use of barium's density by giving patients a solution of barium compound to swallow, before taking **X-rays** of their digestive system. The barium makes the soft digestive organs denser, allowing them to be seen clearly with an X-ray machine.